

LittleReads

Nia's Big Idea

Entrepreneurship

Ages 8–10

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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~~One year after going to school, the children in the neighbourhood walk three kilometres to fetch water from the far stream. They carried heavy buckets on their heads, and their feet ached by the time they got home.~~

Chapter 1: The Problem

"Mama, why do we have to walk so far for water?" Nia asked her mother.

"Because the well near our house dried up two years ago, and no one has fixed it."

"But what about rainwater? Could we collect it?"

Her mother laughed gently. "We would need containers, and a system, and someone who knows how to build it."

Nia thought about this. She did not know how to build a water collection system. But she knew someone who might — Uncle Bello, who was good with his hands.

She also thought about the containers. Her mother and neighbours threw away large plastic drums after using them. What if those drums could be used to collect rainwater?

The pieces of the puzzle were coming together in Nia's mind.

Chapter 2: The Plan

Nia drew a plan on a piece of cardboard. She showed it to Uncle Bello.

"I want to build a rainwater collection system," she explained. "We collect the drums from the neighbours. You help us build the gutters and pipes. And everyone shares the water."

Uncle Bello studied the drawing. "This is clever, Nia. But who will pay for the pipes and materials?"

Nia had thought about that too. "If every family contributes 500 naira, we will have enough. It is less than what they spend buying water from the tanker truck every week."

Uncle Bello smiled. "You have thought of everything. I will help you."

Chapter 3: Building Together

Nia went door to door, explaining her idea. Some people were excited. Others were doubtful.

"A little girl thinks she can solve the water problem?" some whispered.

But Nia did not give up. She showed them her plan, explained the costs, and told them how much they would save.

Slowly, families began to contribute. Uncle Bello collected the materials. The children helped clean the drums. The women helped build the gutter system on the roofs.

After two weeks, the rainwater collection system was ready. Four large drums connected to gutters on five houses. When the next rain came, the drums would fill up.

Chapter 4: The First Rain

Three days later, the rain came.

Nia stood outside with the other children, watching water flow through the gutters and into the drums. For the first time in years, the water was right there — clean, fresh, and free.

Mama Aisha was the first to fill her bucket. "This is wonderful!" she cried. "No more walking three kilometres!"

The neighbourhood celebrated. Everyone had water. The children danced. The elders smiled.

One of the doubtful women came to Nia. "I am sorry I doubted you, child. You have done something wonderful for all of us."

Nia smiled. "It was not just me. It was everyone working together."

Chapter 5: What Nia Learned

That night, Nia thought about what had happened. She had seen a problem, made a plan, and brought people together to solve it.

"Is this what they call entrepreneurship?" she asked her mother.

"Yes," said Mama. "Entrepreneurship is about seeing what people need and finding a way to provide it. You have that gift, Nia."

Nia did not know what she wanted to be when she grew up. But she knew one thing: she would always look for problems to solve, because every problem is a big idea waiting to happen.

And that is exactly how great things begin.

What We Learned

- Entrepreneurship is about identifying problems and creating solutions.
- A good plan helps convince others to support your idea.
- Community collaboration makes big projects possible.
- Even young people can create real change.

Discussion Questions

1. What problem in your neighbourhood would you like to solve?
2. How did Nia convince the doubters to support her?
3. Why is it important for a plan to show how much something costs?

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Thank you for reading!

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